

Photograph by BANDEEP SINGH

## DAGGUMALLA PRASADA RAO, 62

**| TDP | *Chittoor (SC), Andhra Pradesh***



After voluntarily retiring from the Indian Revenue Service in 2019 as a joint income tax commissioner, Rao steered two family-run entities in the construction business. But it was not enough. Ergo, a turn to politics. He joined the TDP in March and won the LS election in June. Now his goal is to see Chittoor develop as an MSME hub.

## NAMDEO KIRSAN, 66

**| CONGRESS | *Gadchiroli-Chimur (ST), Maharashtra***



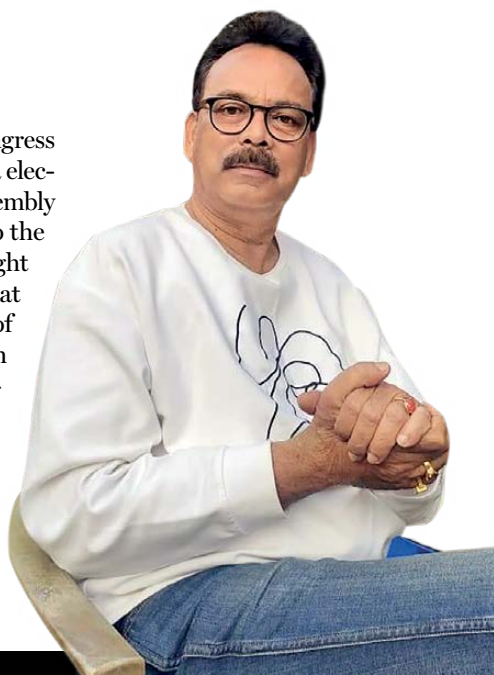
Before joining the excise department, where he served as a district superintendent until his voluntary retirement in 2008 to pursue a career in politics, Kirsan was a college professor in Nagpur. However, it was the support of the influential Vijay Wadettiwar, the leader of the Opposition, that ensured his victory against two-term BJP MP Ashok Nete. A PhD in Gandhian thought, he earned an MBA in 2017.



## SUKHDEO BHAGAT, 63

**| CONGRESS | *Lohardaga (ST), Jharkhand***

In 2019, Sukhdeo Bhagat switched from the Congress to the BJP after narrowly losing the Lok Sabha election. The switch did not pay off as he lost the assembly poll later that year by a big margin. It was back to the Congress in January 2022, on whose ticket he fought this year's election and wrested the Lohardaga seat from the BJP with a respectable victory margin of over 139,000 votes. A postgraduate in History from Delhi University, Bhagat worked first as a probationary officer in a bank and then as a deputy collector from 1997 to 2005. It was then that the political bug bit him, and he has never looked back since.



*–Amarnath K. Menon, Ajay Sukumaran, Rohit Parihar, Dhaval S. Kulkarni and Amitabh Srivastava*